

Name: _____

Aquanaut Safety Field Guide

Scouts follow **Safe Swim Defense** every time we swim. Remember the 8 parts with this silly sentence:

**Quick Pups Swim Rapidly,
Lazy Alligators Bask Daily**

Q**Qualified Supervision**

A trained adult is in charge.

P**Personal Health Review**

Tell an adult if you feel sick.

S**Safe Area**

The water has been checked and marked.

R**Response Personnel**

Lifeguards are ready to help.

L**Lookout**

Someone watches the whole area.

A**Ability Groups**

Swim only in your area.

B**Buddy System**

Never swim alone!

D**Discipline**

Follow the rules. Walk, don't run.

Ability Groups

Nonswimmer: shallow water

Beginner: water just over your head

Swimmer: the deep area

Your swim test decides your group. Practice to move up!

When you hear "Buddy Check!"**1**

Grab your buddy's hand.

2

Raise your hands up high.

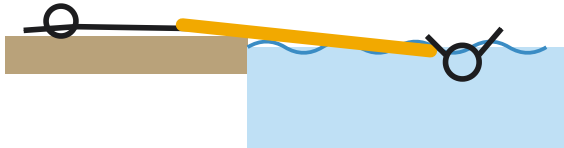
3

Freeze and stay quiet while adults count.

Reach or Throw — Don't Go!

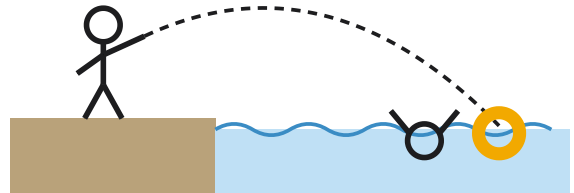
The **order of rescue** goes from safest to most dangerous for the rescuer.

1 REACH



Lie down on the deck and reach out with a pole, pool noodle, towel, or your arm. Stay low so you don't get pulled in!

2 THROW



Too far to reach? Throw something that floats. Hold the rope end, yell **"Rope!"**, and throw it **past** them.

3 ROW

A trained adult uses a boat. **Adults only.**

4 GO

A trained lifeguard swims out with a float. **Lifeguards only.**

YELL for help → REACH or THROW → DON'T GO!

Look around! Circle things you could use to REACH or THROW:

pool noodle · towel · rope · life jacket · empty cooler · tree branch · shirt ·
ring buoy · kickboard · paddle

(Trick question: they all work!)

Beat the Chill!

Hypothermia (hi-po-THER-mee-uh) is when your body loses heat faster than it can make it.

Water steals heat about **25 times faster** than air — even on a sunny day!

Warning Sign #1: SHIVERING

Shivering is your body's alarm bell. **When you shiver, get out, dry off, and warm up.**

If it gets worse, watch for the UMBLES



Stumbles

tripping, clumsy



Mumbles

can't talk clearly



Fumbles

fingers don't work



Grumbles

cranky, confused

Also look for **blue lips** and **blue fingers**. People who are too cold often don't notice — **that's why buddies watch each other!**



Prevent it

- ☐ Get out when you start shivering
- ☐ Towel off right away
- ☐ Put on dry clothes or a sweatshirt
- ☐ Stay out of the wind
- ☐ Eat a snack and drink water



Treat it

- ☐ **Tell an adult right away!**
- ☐ Get out of the water and wind
- ☐ Swap wet clothes for dry ones
- ☐ Wrap up in a blanket or towel
- ☐ Warm (not hot) drink if they're awake

SAFETY FIRST

If someone is stumbling, confused, or super sleepy, it's an emergency. **Get an adult to call 911.**

Swim Day Skills

Remember: requirements that say “**attempt**” mean **try your best**. Trying earns it!

Treading Water: stay up, stay calm

- 1 **Stay tall** like you're standing up, chin at the water.
- 2 **Arms: “spread the peanut butter.”** Hands flat, sweep them out and in just under the water.
- 3 **Legs: pick one.** Bicycle (pedal slowly), scissor (one forward, one back), or frog kick.
- 4 **Go slow and breathe.** Splashing tires you out. Relaxing keeps you up!

My goal: _____ seconds I did: _____ seconds

Swimmer Test

- 1 Jump in feet first where it's over your head.
- 2 Swim **75 yards** with strong strokes (crawl, breaststroke, sidestroke, or trudgen).
- 3 Swim **25 yards** of easy backstroke.
- 4 No stopping! Make at least one sharp turn.
- 5 Finish by **floating** to rest.

Beginner Test

- 1 Jump in feet first where it's over your head.
- 2 Level off and swim **25 feet**.
- 3 Stop, turn around sharply.
- 4 Swim back to where you started.

Not a beginner or swimmer yet? You're a **nonswimmer** for now — and every swimmer started there!

My Swim Day

My buddy: _____ My ability group: _____

Something I want to practice next: _____

Name: _____

Aquanaut Word Search

Words go across →, down ↓, or diagonally ↘.

B	L	I	F	E	G	U	A	R	D	B	G	M	U
F	M	H	Y	P	O	T	H	E	R	M	I	A	K
A	Q	U	A	N	A	U	T	S	P	L	A	S	H
S	E	O	B	E	G	I	N	N	E	R	P	R	R
S	I	L	V	T	K	L	D	A	L	E	W	E	W
D	A	A	B	J	J	O	S	G	K	F	U	S	M
I	R	F	L	I	A	O	W	H	B	U	H	C	I
V	E	W	E	G	D	K	I	T	T	U	D	U	A
W	A	H	S	T	C	O	M	R	D	H	D	E	E
J	C	I	A	H	Y	U	M	E	F	S	R	D	N
T	H	S	H	A	I	T	E	A	O	L	N	O	Y
V	S	T	K	M	V	V	R	D	K	W	O	E	W
J	U	L	M	P	L	O	E	O	V	S	A	A	A
W	A	E	P	G	R	D	K	R	V	J	N	G	T

AQUANAUT

BEGINNER

BUDDY

FLOAT

HYPOTHERMIA

LIFEGUARD

LOOKOUT

REACH

RESCUE

SAFETY

SHIVER

SPLASH

SWIMMER

THROW

TREAD

WHISTLE

Name: _____

Aquanaut Challenge

How much do you remember? Fill in the blanks.

1. Never swim alone! Always swim with a _____.
2. If someone is in trouble in the water, a Cub Scout should yell for help, then _____ or _____ — but DON'T GO!
3. The first warning sign that you are getting too cold is _____.
4. Name the four "Umbles":

5. The person who watches the whole swim area from a spot where they can see everyone is the _____.
6. How far do you swim in the swimmer test? _____ yards
7. On a wet pool deck, you should always _____, never run.
8. What are the three ability groups?

Draw it!

Draw yourself doing a **reach** or **throw** rescue the safe way.

Name: _____

My Aquanaut Tracker

Check off each requirement as you finish it. Have your den leader initial it!

Done	#	Requirement	Date	Leader initials
☐	1	I can tell the safety steps we take before swimming (Safe Swim Defense).		
☐	2	I can explain the order of rescue and showed a reach and a throw rescue from land.		
☐	3	I learned how to prevent and treat hypothermia.		
☐	4	I tried treading water.		
☐	5	I tried the swimmer test.		
☐	6	I had 30+ minutes of free swim with my buddy, in my ability group.		

My Aquanaut Promise

Whenever I'm near water, I will:

- ☐ Always swim with a buddy.
- ☐ Stay in my ability group's area.
- ☐ Listen to lifeguards and adults.
- ☐ Reach or Throw — but never Go — if someone needs help.
- ☐ Get out and warm up when I start shivering.

Signed: _____ Date: _____